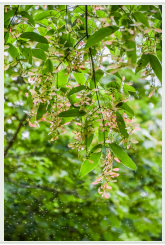
Emerald Jade Maple

Acer fabri

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

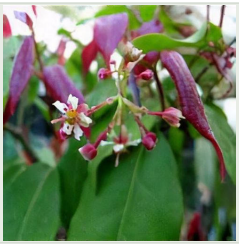
GARDENS Rockery: 1 **TOTAL 1**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available



Flower
Library candidate



Leaf close-up
Library candidate

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Evergreen
Mature size: 20–30 ft (often smaller in cultivation). Confirmed by NC State, UF/IFAS, Woodlanders, plant lust. × 12–30 ft (sources range 12–15 ft to 20–30 ft). **Open:** Spread range varies; no tight three-source agreement on a single figure.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Suitable for Zone 8a. Hardy Zones 8–10 (sources vary 7–10). Evergreen to semi-evergreen in Atlanta. Leaves may drop after hard cold below ~20°F. Performs well in southern landscapes. Restart pass (2026-10-13): NC State confirms good performance in Zone 8+, evergreen in warmer climates, leaves drop near 20°F, 20–30 ft. Woodlanders lists Zones 8–9, 25–30 ft, evergreen. UF/IFAS has a Faber's Maple publication. [https://plants.ces.ncsu.edu/plants/acer-fabri/ ; https://woodlanders.net/products/acer-fabri]
Sun: Full sun to part shade. Prefers some shade in hotter climates.
Water: Regular to medium. Prefers moist, well-drained soil.
Soil: Well-drained, rich, acidic preferred. Adaptable.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun to part shade in well-drained, moist soil. Protect from strong winds and late frosts. Water regularly until established. Minimal pruning. Suitable as small specimen or patio tree.
Soil prep: Well-drained, rich, acidic preferred. Adaptable.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Native to Vietnam and China. Introduced to Western cultivation by E.H. Wilson around the early 20th century. Common name "Emerald Jade" attributed to Dr. Donglin Zhang (UGA).
Form / habit: Small evergreen to semi-evergreen tree. Dense, multi-stemmed, rounded to broadly columnar. Slow to moderate growth.
Foliage: None or limited (evergreen). May show red new growth. Semi-evergreen behavior in colder winters.
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Dark brown to gray. Young growth reddish-purple.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Shares common maple pests and diseases (insects, leaf issues). No serious problems uniquely stated for the species. Low maintenance when sited correctly. **Open:** Cultivar- or species-specific health data is thin.
Not stated
Additional:
- Unlobed, glossy dark green leaves (lanceolate to oblong). - Red new growth and red samaras. - Evergreen in mild winters; semi-evergreen after hard cold. - Rare in cultivation.